Phase 6: Songs & Wise Words

The Bible's poetry books teach us how to talk to God, sing to God, trust God when life hurts, and live wisely every day.

At a Glance	
Month	Month 6
Books covered	Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs (**5 books**)
Bible section(s)	Poetry / Wisdom (books 18–22 of the Bible). **This phase completes the Poetry/Wisdom section!**
Big Idea	God gave us songs and wise words so we can talk to Him honestly, praise Him joyfully, and follow His way, which is the wise way.
Memory Verse (all ages)	"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105, NIV)
Little Lambs verse	"Your word is a lamp for my feet." (Psalm 119:105)
Bonus verse (Trailblazers & Ambassadors)	"Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding." (Proverbs 3:5)
Theme color	Lamplight gold (with deep teal)
Phase symbol / badge	A harp with a glowing oil lamp beside it (the "Lamp & Harp" badge)
Running total of books learned	**22 of 66** (Law 5 + History 12 + Poetry 5 ✔)

> 🎉 **Fun fact:** We now know **22** books. Psalm 119 (where our memory verse comes from) has **22** sections, one for each letter of the Hebrew alphabet!

The Big Idea (in kid words)

The Bible has a whole shelf of poetry books: songs, prayers and wise sayings. Job shows us we can trust God even when life hurts. Psalms gives us songs to sing to God when we're happy, sad, scared or sorry. Proverbs teaches us how to make wise choices. Ecclesiastes reminds us that only God makes life really matter. And Song of Songs shows that God made love and marriage good.

How this points to Jesus: Jesus is the "wisdom of God" (1 Corinthians 1:24). Jesus sang the Psalms and even prayed Psalm 22 on the cross: "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" Jesus is the Good Shepherd of Psalm 23 (John 10:11). Job cried out for a "Redeemer" (Job 19:25) and someone to stand between him and God (Job 9:33); Jesus is that Redeemer. Jesus is "greater than Solomon" (Matthew 12:42), and He gives us life that is full and not meaningless (John 10:10). The Bible calls Jesus the Bridegroom who loves His people, the church (Ephesians 5:25).

The Books in Easy Words

> Teacher tip: Hold up the Bible and open it right in the middle. You'll usually land in Psalms! The Poetry books sit in the middle of the Bible, like a heart in the middle of a body.

18. Job

- **How to say it:** "JOHB" (rhymes with "robe," not like a "job" you go to)
- **How to spell it:** Job, J-O-B (one syllable, just 3 letters!)
- **Section:** Poetry / Wisdom
- **Traditional author:** Unknown. Some Jewish tradition says Moses. The story is set very long ago, probably around the time of Abraham.
- **One-sentence kid summary:** Job was a good man who lost almost everything, asked God hard questions, and learned that God is great and wise and can be trusted even when we don't understand.
- **In one word:** *Trust*
- **Key people:** Job, his wife, Satan ("the accuser"), Job's three friends Eliphaz, Bildad and Zophar, a younger man named Elihu, God
- **Key stories:** Job is blameless and loves God (ch. 1); Satan says Job only loves God because God gives him good things (ch. 1–2); Job loses his animals, servants, children and health, but says "The LORD gave and the LORD has taken away; may the name of the LORD be praised" (1:21); his friends sit with him silently for 7 days, then wrongly say he must have sinned (ch. 2–31); "I know that my redeemer lives" (19:25); God speaks from a storm: "Where were you when I laid the earth's foundation?" (ch. 38–41); God restores Job and gives him twice as much as before (ch. 42)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** Job wished for someone to stand between him and God (9:33) and believed in a living Redeemer (19:25). Jesus is that Redeemer! Jesus, too, was completely innocent and suffered terribly, and God brought Him through to glory.
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 🙌 Hands open upward, then folded over your heart ("I'll trust You, God"). Picture: a man sitting on the ground looking up at a storm cloud.

19. Psalms

- **How to say it:** "SAHMZ" (the P is silent! It's a sneaky letter)
- **How to spell it:** Psalms, P-S-A-L-M-S (one syllable; starts with a silent P!)
- **Section:** Poetry / Wisdom
- **Traditional author:** Many writers. King David wrote about half (73 psalms have his name). Others were written by Asaph, the sons of Korah, Solomon (Psalms 72 and 127), Moses (Psalm 90), and others. Many are unnamed.
- **One-sentence kid summary:** Psalms is God's songbook: 150 songs and prayers that teach us to talk to God about everything, happy, sad, scared, sorry and thankful.
- **In one word:** *Praise*
- **Key people:** David, Asaph, the sons of Korah, Moses, Solomon

- **Key stories / famous psalms:** Psalm 1 (the happy person is like a tree by water); Psalm 8 (how big God is, how special we are); Psalm 23 ("The LORD is my shepherd"); Psalm 46 ("Be still, and know that I am God"); Psalm 51 (David says sorry); Psalm 100 ("Shout for joy to the LORD"); Psalm 117 (the shortest chapter in the Bible, only 2 verses!); Psalm 119 (the longest chapter, 176 verses, all about God's Word); Psalm 139 ("I am fearfully and wonderfully made"); Psalm 150 ("Let everything that has breath praise the LORD")
- **Where Jesus shows up:** Jesus is the Good Shepherd (Psalm 23; John 10:11). On the cross He prayed Psalm 22:1 ("My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?") and Psalm 31:5 ("Into your hands I commit my spirit"). Psalm 118:22 says the rejected stone becomes the cornerstone, and Jesus said that was about Him (Matthew 21:42). The New Testament quotes the Psalms more than almost any other Old Testament book!
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 🎵 Strum a pretend harp (David played the harp). Picture: a harp with music notes.

20. Proverbs

- **How to say it:** "PRAH-vurbz"
- **How to spell it:** Prov-erbs, P-R-O-V-E-R-B-S (2 syllables)
- **Section:** Poetry / Wisdom
- **Traditional author:** Mostly King Solomon (1:1), who wrote 3,000 proverbs (1 Kings 4:32). Also "sayings of the wise" (22:17), Agur (ch. 30) and King Lemuel (ch. 31). Some were collected by King Hezekiah's men (25:1).
- **One-sentence kid summary:** Proverbs is a book of short, wise sayings that teach us how to make good choices with our words, friends, work, money and hearts.
- **In one word:** *Wisdom*
- **Key people:** Solomon, a father teaching his son, "Lady Wisdom" and "Lady Folly" (two characters who call out to people), the noble woman of chapter 31
- **Key sayings:** "The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge" (1:7); "Trust in the LORD with all your heart" (3:5–6); "Above all else, guard your heart" (4:23); "Go to the ant, you sluggard" (6:6); "A gentle answer turns away wrath" (15:1); "A friend loves at all times" (17:17); "Walk with the wise and become wise" (13:20); "a wife of noble character" (ch. 31)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** Jesus is the wisdom of God (1 Corinthians 1:24, 30); "in him are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge" (Colossians 2:3). Proverbs 8 describes Wisdom being with God at creation, and the New Testament says Jesus was with God at creation (John 1:1–3).
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 🧠 Tap your head with one finger ("think wise!"). Picture: an ant carrying food.

> **Fun tip:** Proverbs has **31 chapters**, and most months have about 31 days. Read the chapter that matches today's date!

21. Ecclesiastes

- **How to say it:** "ih-KLEE-zee-AS-teez"

- **How to spell it:** Ec-cle-si-as-tes, E-C-C-L-E-S-I-A-S-T-E-S (5 syllables; the hardest book name yet!)
- **Section:** Poetry / Wisdom
- **Traditional author:** "The Teacher" (Hebrew *Qoheleth*), "son of David, king in Jerusalem" (1:1). Traditionally Solomon.
- **One-sentence kid summary:** A wise teacher tries everything (money, fun, work, learning) and finds that nothing "under the sun" makes life last or matter, except loving God and obeying Him.
- **In one word:** *Meaning*
- **Key people:** The Teacher (Solomon)
- **Key sayings:** "Meaningless! Meaningless!... Everything is meaningless" (1:2; the Hebrew word means "vapor" or "breath," like the cloud you make on a cold day); "There is a time for everything" (3:1–8); "He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the human heart" (3:11); "Two are better than one" and "a cord of three strands is not quickly broken" (4:9–12); "Remember your Creator in the days of your youth" (12:1); "Fear God and keep his commandments" (12:13)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** Ecclesiastes asks, "What lasts?" Jesus answers: "I have come that they may have life, and have it to the full" (John 10:10). Ecclesiastes says wise words are "given by one shepherd" (12:11), and Jesus is the Good Shepherd. Because Jesus rose from the dead, our work for Him is "not in vain" (1 Corinthians 15:58).
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** 💨 Blow a puff of air into your hand, then point up to God ("Life is a breath, so remember God!"). Picture: a puff of steam beside a clock.

22. Song of Songs

- **How to say it:** "SONG uv SONGZ" (also called **Song of Solomon** in some Bibles)
- **How to spell it:** Song of Songs, S-O-N-G O-F S-O-N-G-S (3 words!)
- **Section:** Poetry / Wisdom
- **Traditional author:** Solomon (1:1, "Solomon's Song of Songs")
- **One-sentence kid summary:** A beautiful love poem about a bride and groom who love each other very much, showing that God made love and marriage good.
- **In one word:** *Love*
- **Key people:** The bride (a young woman), the groom (connected with King Solomon), the bride's friends ("daughters of Jerusalem")
- **Key sayings:** "Solomon's Song of Songs" means "the best song of all" (1:1); "Catch for us the foxes, the little foxes that ruin the vineyards" (2:15); "Love is as strong as death" (8:6); "Many waters cannot quench love; rivers cannot sweep it away" (8:7)
- **Where Jesus shows up:** The Bible often describes God's love for His people like a groom's love for his bride (Isaiah 62:5; Hosea 2). Jesus is called the Bridegroom (Mark 2:19–20), and the church is His bride (Ephesians 5:25–32; Revelation 19:7). Jesus' love is truly "stronger than death," because He beat death!
- **Hand motion / picture symbol:** ❤️ Make a heart with your hands, then sing a "la-la" note. Picture: a heart with a flower.

> **Remember the shape of the Poetry shelf:** **J**ob, **P**salms, **P**roverbs, **E**cclesiastes, **S**ong. Kid phrase:

> "**J**esus **P**uts **P**eace in **E**very **S**ong!"

Teacher Preparation

Background for the teacher

The five books from Job to Song of Songs are often called the **Poetry** or **Wisdom** books. Unlike the History books, they don't move the story along in time. Instead, they show how God's people pray, worship, think and live. Most of the content is Hebrew poetry.

- **Hebrew poetry rhymes ideas, not sounds.** This is called *parallelism*. One line says something, and the next line repeats it, builds on it, or contrasts it. Example: "Your word is a lamp for my feet, / a light on my path" (same idea twice). "A gentle answer turns away wrath, / but a harsh word stirs up anger" (contrast). Teach this to Trailblazers and Ambassadors; it unlocks the whole section.
- **Job** wrestles with the question "Why do good people suffer?" The opening (ch. 1–2) is a prose story. The middle (ch. 3–37) is a long poetic debate in which Job's friends insist that suffering is always punishment for sin. Job insists he is innocent and demands an answer from God. In chapters 38–41, God speaks "out of the storm," not explaining Job's suffering but revealing His power and wisdom in creation. Job humbles himself (42:1–6). God says the friends were wrong and Job spoke rightly (42:7), and He restores Job (42:10–17). Key lesson: suffering is not always punishment, and God is trustworthy even when unexplained.
- **Psalms** is a collection of 150 songs and prayers, written over about 1,000 years (Moses to after the exile), divided into five "books" (1–41, 42–72, 73–89, 90–106, 107–150), each ending with a short praise (a "doxology"). Main types: *praise* (Ps 100, 150), *thanksgiving* (Ps 107), *lament*, or honest complaint/sadness (Ps 13, 42, 88), *repentance* (Ps 51), *trust* (Ps 23, 46), *wisdom* (Ps 1, 119) and *royal/messianic* psalms about the king (Ps 2, 110). The laments are important: they teach kids they can bring sadness and anger to God.
- **Proverbs** contains short sayings about everyday life. Proverbs are general principles, not guaranteed promises (e.g., 22:6 describes how things usually go, not a contract). The foundation is "the fear of the LORD" (1:7), meaning deep reverence, awe and trust that leads to obedience, not terror.
- **Ecclesiastes** is honest about life's frustrations. The key word, *hevel* (translated "meaningless" in the NIV, "vanity" in the KJV), literally means "vapor" or "breath," something real but fleeting that can't be grasped. The phrase "under the sun" (used about 29 times) means "life seen only from an earthly view, without God." The conclusion is to enjoy God's gifts, remember your Creator, and fear God (12:1, 13–14).
- **Song of Songs** is love poetry celebrating romantic love between a husband and wife. Christians have read it in two complementary ways: (1) a celebration of God's good gift of married love, and (2) a picture of God's love for His people / Christ's love for the church. For children, emphasize that God made love, that marriage is His good idea, and that His love for us is stronger than anything.

Key truths to emphasize

1. **We can talk to God about anything.** The Psalms include happy, sad, angry and scared prayers.
2. **God is worthy of praise** all the time (Psalm 150; Job 1:21).
3. **Wisdom starts with God** (Proverbs 1:7). Smart isn't the same as wise.
4. **God can be trusted even when we don't understand** (Job; Proverbs 3:5).
5. **Life finds its meaning in God** (Ecclesiastes 12:13).
6. **God's love is strong and faithful** (Song of Songs 8:6–7; Psalm 136: "His love endures forever," 26 times!).
7. **God's Word guides us** like a lamp in the dark (Psalm 119:105).

Timeline and map notes

- These books don't follow a timeline, but you can place them:
  - **Job:** setting probably around the time of the patriarchs (about 2000 BC); land of **Uz** (likely east of Israel, toward Edom/Arabia).
  - **Psalms:** from Moses (about 1400 BC) through David (1000 BC) to after the exile (about 500 BC). Most were written for worship in Jerusalem.
  - **Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs:** connected with Solomon (970–930 BC), in Jerusalem. (Remember him from Phase 4!)
- Show kids on last month's timeline where David and Solomon were, and draw a harp and a lamp there.
- A simple illustration: an ancient oil lamp gave only enough light for the next step or two, not the whole road. That's what Psalm 119:105 means: God's Word shows us the next step.

Handling sensitive content by age

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers (11–13)	Ambassadors (14–17)
Job's children die (Job 1:18–19)	"Job lost almost everything, even people he loved. He was very, very sad. But he still trusted God."	"A great wind knocked down the house and Job's children died. Job was heartbroken, but he still worshiped God."	Read 1:13–22. Discuss grief and trust.	Discuss the problem of evil (see Big Questions). Be sensitive: some teens have lost loved ones.
Satan in Job	"There is an enemy called Satan, but God is much stronger and is always in charge."	"Satan accused Job. God set limits on what Satan could do (1:12; 2:6)."	Discuss that Satan is real but limited and under God's authority.	Discuss the heavenly court scene as a window into spiritual reality; avoid speculation.

Topic	Little Lambs (4–6)	Explorers (7–10)	Trailblazers (11–13)	Ambassadors (14–17)
Sad and angry Psalms	"We can tell God when we're sad."	"Some psalms are sad. God wants us to be honest."	Read Psalm 13: complaint → trust → praise.	Discuss imprecatory psalms (e.g., 137:9, 109) as honest cries for justice that leave vengeance to God (Romans 12:19).
Song of Songs	"God made moms and dads love each other." Don't read the text aloud.	"A love song about a husband and wife. God made marriage." Read only 8:6–7.	Explain it's romantic poetry for married love. Read 2:15; 8:6–7.	Discuss God's design for love, sexuality within marriage, waiting (2:7, "Do not arouse or awaken love until it so desires"), and Christ's love for the church. Consider a same-gender small-group setting.
Ecclesiastes' "meaningless"	Skip the word; say "Only God makes things last."	"Without God, things don't last. With God, life matters!"	Discuss "under the sun."	Discuss nihilism vs. Christian hope; link to 1 Corinthians 15:58.
Grief / loss (any week)	Be gentle; let kids share.	Pray for those who are hurting.	Let them share if they want.	Offer a follow-up with a pastor or parent if a teen shares serious grief or depression.

> **Care note:** Job and the lament Psalms may stir up feelings for kids who have lost a parent, grandparent or pet, or whose families are going through hard times. Watch faces, keep tissues handy, and follow up with parents if a child seems distressed. If a child shares something that suggests they are unsafe, follow your church's child-safety reporting procedures.

Common kid questions (with simple answers)

- **"Why do bad things happen to good people?"** We don't always know why. The world is broken because of sin, and there is an enemy who wants to hurt us. But Job shows that God is still good, still in control, and still with us. In the end, God will make everything right. Jesus Himself suffered, so He knows how we feel.
- **"Did God make bad things happen to Job?"** God allowed Satan to test Job, but He set limits (Job 1:12; 2:6). Satan caused the harm. God was still in charge, and He brought good out of it.
- **"Why is the P in Psalms silent?"** The word comes from Greek *psalmos*, meaning a song played on a stringed instrument. In Greek, the P was pronounced, but in English we dropped the sound and kept the letter.
- **"Did David really write the Psalms?"** He wrote many of them (about 73 have his name). Others were written by other worship leaders.
- **"Do proverbs always come true?"** They are wise guidelines about how life usually works when we follow God's way. They aren't magic promises, but they're always wise.
- **"Why does Ecclesiastes say everything is meaningless?"** The Teacher is showing what life is like *without* God: like trying to catch a puff of air. At the end he says that what really matters is loving and obeying God.

- **"Why is a love song in the Bible?"** God invented love! He made marriage, and He's happy when husbands and wives love each other. It also helps us see how much God loves us.

Month at a Glance

Week	Passage	Lesson Title	Key Point	📺 Video	🎮 Game	🖍️ Activity
1	Job 1:1–3, 13–22; 2:11–13; 38:1–7; 42:10–17	When Life Hurts, God Is Still Good	We can trust God even when we don't understand.	SharefaithKids "Job"; BibleJourneyTV "Job"; BibleProject "Overview: Job"	Storm and Stars Freeze	"Where Were You?" star chart
2	Psalms 23; 100; 150; 119:105	God's Songbook	We can talk and sing to God about everything.	SharefaithKids "Psalm 23"; BibleJourneyTV "David the shepherd"; BibleProject "Overview: Psalms"	Shepherd and Sheep Tag	Psalm 150 instruments
3	Proverbs 1:7; 3:5–6; 6:6–8; 15:1; 17:17	Wise Choices	Wisdom starts with trusting and obeying God.	SharefaithKids "Wisdom" / "Proverbs"; BibleJourneyTV "Solomon's wisdom"; BibleProject "Overview: Proverbs"	Wise or Foolish Four Corners	Ant Hill wisdom craft
4	Ecclesiastes 3:1–8, 11; 4:9–12; 12:1, 13; Song of Songs 8:6–7	What Really Matters & God's Strong Love	Only God makes life last; God's love is stronger than anything.	SharefaithKids "God's love"; BibleJourneyTV "Solomon"; BibleProject "Overview: Ecclesiastes" & "Overview: Song of Songs"	A Time for Everything Charades	Three-Strand Cord bracelet
5 (optional)	Psalm 150	Praise Party! (Review & Fun Sunday)	Celebrate 22 books and three full sections!	Rewatch favorite	Harp Hot Potato + Poetry Bible Bowl	Praise parade & badges

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Weekly Lessons

Week 1: When Life Hurts, God Is Still Good

Scripture: Job 1:1–3, 13–22; 2:7–13; 19:25; 38:1–7; 42:1–6, 10–17

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that Job trusted God even when he lost almost everything, that God is great and wise beyond our understanding, and that we can trust Him when life hurts.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* A piece of embroidery or cross-stitch (or a woven potholder), turned to the messy back side first.

1. Show the back side: tangled, knotted threads. "What do you think this is? Does it look like a mess?"
2. Turn it over to reveal the beautiful picture.
3. Say: "Sometimes our lives look like the messy side. We can't see what God is doing. But God sees the whole picture. Today we'll meet a man named Job who learned to trust God even when everything looked like a mess."

📖 **Story script**

> In the land of Uz lived a man named **Job** (say "JOHB"). Job loved God and always tried to do what was right. God had blessed him with seven sons and three daughters, and thousands of sheep, camels, oxen and donkeys. He was the greatest man in all the East!
>
> One day, Satan, God's enemy, came before God. God said, "Have you noticed My servant Job? There's no one on earth like him." Satan sneered, "Of course Job loves You. You give him everything! Take it away, and he'll turn against You." God said, "You may test him, but you may not touch Job himself."
>
> Then terrible news came, one messenger after another. "Robbers stole your oxen and donkeys!" "Fire fell and burned up your sheep!" "Raiders took your camels!" And the worst news: "A great wind knocked down the house where your children were, and they all died."
>
> Job was so sad that he tore his robe and fell to the ground. But then he did something amazing: he **worshiped**. He said, "**The LORD gave, and the LORD has taken away. May the name of the LORD be praised.**"
>
> Then Job got sick with painful sores all over his body. Three friends came to visit. At first they were good friends: they sat with him quietly for seven days. But then they started talking: "Job, you must have done something really bad for this to happen!" But that wasn't true.
>
> Job was hurting, and he asked God lots of hard questions: "Why, God? Why is this happening?" Even then, Job said, "**I know that my Redeemer lives!**"
>
> Finally, God answered Job from a big storm. But God didn't explain *why*. Instead, God asked Job questions: "Where were you when I made the earth? Have you ever told the sun to rise in the morning? Can you count the stars? Do you feed the lions? Do you tell the eagle where to fly?"
>
> Job realized: "God, You are so great and so wise! You know things I could never understand. I trust You." God told Job's friends they had been wrong. Then God blessed Job again with twice as many animals as before, and seven more sons and three more daughters. Job lived a long, happy life.

> When life hurts, we might not know why. But we can always know **Who**: God, who is great, who is good, and who loves us. Our Redeemer, Jesus, lives!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Focus on two things: Job was sad, and Job still trusted God. Teach a simple response: when something sad happens, we can say, "I trust You, God." Use a stuffed sheep and camel to show what Job had.
- **Explorers:** Act out God's questions from Job 38–39. Kids take turns asking "Can you...?" questions about nature ("Can you make it snow?"). Answer together: "No, but God can!"
- **Trailblazers:** Discuss why Job's friends were wrong (they assumed all suffering is punishment). Compare John 9:1–3 (the man born blind).
- **Ambassadors:** Read Job 42:7. God says Job spoke rightly, even though Job complained loudly. What does that teach about honesty with God? Discuss how to be a good friend to someone who is suffering (Job 2:13: just be there).

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Was Job happy or sad when bad things happened? (Sad) 2) Did Job still love God? (Yes!) 3) What can you say to God when you're sad? ("I trust You, God.")
- *Explorers:* 1) What did Job say after losing everything? 2) What did Job's friends get wrong? 3) What questions did God ask Job?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do you think God didn't tell Job *why* he suffered? 2) Is it okay to ask God "why"? 3) How can you be a good friend to someone who's going through something hard?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Satan claimed Job only loved God for His gifts. Do you love God for who He is or for what He gives? 2) What's the difference between honest questions and turning away from God? 3) How does Jesus' suffering help us trust God in ours?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Job" / "the story of Job" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Job | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Job" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Job | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors (Explorers with pauses) | Likely title: "Overview: Job" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Job |

Follow-up questions: 1) What did the video say about why Job suffered? 2) What did God show Job when He spoke from the storm?

> Preview every video first. Searching "Job" may bring up unrelated results ("job" as work), so look for the Bible story titles.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Storm and Stars Freeze* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *"Where Were You?" Star Chart* (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** J-O-B (the shortest book name in the Bible!). Remember: it's "JOHB." Start the memory verse: "Your word is a lamp for my feet..."

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> God, sometimes life is hard and I don't understand. Thank You that You are great and good. Help me trust You like Job did. Thank You that Jesus, my Redeemer, lives! Amen.

Week 2: God's Songbook

Scripture: Psalm 23; Psalm 100; Psalm 150; Psalm 13 (optional for older); Psalm 119:105

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that Psalms is the Bible's songbook, that David the shepherd wrote many psalms, and that we can talk and sing to God about everything.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* A shoebox "feelings box" with four emoji faces taped on the sides (happy, sad, scared, sorry), a music player or instrument.

1. Roll the box like a big die. Whatever face lands on top, ask a child, "When do you feel this way?"
2. After a few rolls, say: "Did you know there are songs in the Bible for *every one* of these feelings? The book of Psalms is God's songbook!"
3. Play or sing a short worship song.

📖 **Story script**

> Do you remember David, the shepherd boy who fought Goliath and became king? Long before he was king, David spent many days and nights out in the fields taking care of his sheep. He found green grass for them to eat and quiet water for them to drink. When a lion or bear came, he protected them. When a sheep got lost, he went looking for it.
>
> Out in the fields, David played his harp and made up songs to God. One day he thought, "God takes care of me the way I take care of my sheep!" And he wrote a song:
>
> "**The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing.** He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters... Even though I walk through the darkest valley, I will fear no evil, for you are with me."
>
> David wrote many songs. When he was happy, he wrote happy songs: "Shout for joy to the LORD, all the earth!" When he was scared and enemies were chasing him, he wrote songs asking God for help. When he did something wrong, he wrote a song telling God he was sorry and asking for a clean heart (Psalm 51). Sometimes he even wrote sad songs: "How long, LORD? Will you forget me forever?" (Psalm 13). But even his sad songs usually end with trusting God: "But I trust in your unfailing love."
>
> Other people wrote psalms too: Moses, Solomon, and temple singers called the sons of Korah and Asaph. Altogether, there are **150 psalms**. God's people sang them in the temple, and Jesus sang

> them too!
>
> The very last psalm, Psalm 150, is a big praise party. "Praise God with trumpets! Praise Him with harps! Praise Him with tambourines and dancing! Praise Him with clashing cymbals!" And the very last verse says: "**Let everything that has breath praise the LORD!**"
>
> Do you have breath? *(Everyone breathe in and out!)* Then you can praise the LORD! Whether you're happy, sad, scared or sorry, you can always talk and sing to God. He's listening.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Teach Psalm 23:1 with motions: "The LORD (point up) is my shepherd (hold a pretend staff), I lack nothing (shake head, hands out)." End with a noisy Psalm 150 praise parade with shakers.
- **Explorers:** Find Psalm 23, Psalm 117 (shortest) and Psalm 119 (longest) in their Bibles. Count the verses of each. Explain that in Psalms, each chapter is a whole song.
- **Trailblazers:** Teach parallelism. Read Psalm 119:105 and Psalm 19:1 and find how the second line repeats the first. Then read Psalm 13 and trace the movement: complaint (vv. 1–2) → request (vv. 3–4) → trust and praise (vv. 5–6).
- **Ambassadors:** Have them write their own short psalm (4–8 lines) following the lament pattern (complaint → request → trust → praise) about something real in their lives. Invite volunteers to read them aloud.

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who is our shepherd? (God / Jesus) 2) What instrument did David play? (Harp) 3) Can you praise God? (Yes! Everything that has breath!)
- *Explorers:* 1) How many psalms are there? (150) 2) How is God like a shepherd? 3) What feeling would you write a song to God about?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do you think God put sad songs in the Bible? 2) What's the "darkest valley" in Psalm 23, and how does God help there? 3) What does Psalm 119:105 mean when it calls God's Word a lamp?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Jesus prayed Psalm 22:1 on the cross. Read Psalm 22. What else in it sounds like the crucifixion? 2) Why might honest lament be a sign of faith rather than lack of faith? 3) How could you use the Psalms in your own prayer life this week?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "Psalm 23" / "The Lord is my shepherd" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Psalm+23 | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "David the shepherd" / "Psalms" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Psalms | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | Likely title: "Overview: Psalms" (also called "Book of Psalms"); bonus: their "Psalms" series | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Psalms |

Follow-up questions: 1) What kinds of feelings show up in the Psalms? 2) How is Jesus connected to the Psalms?

> Preview every video first.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Shepherd and Sheep Tag* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Psalm 150 Instruments* (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** P-S-A-L-M-S. Watch out for the silent P! Practice the whole memory verse with motions: "Your word" (open hands like a book) "is a lamp" (hold up a pretend lamp) "for my feet" (point to feet) "a light" (wiggle fingers like rays) "on my path" (hand moves forward like a road).

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> Dear Jesus, You are my Good Shepherd. Thank You that I can talk to You when I'm happy, sad, scared or sorry. I want to praise You with everything I have! Amen.

Week 3: Wise Choices

Scripture: Proverbs 1:7; 3:5–6; 4:23; 6:6–8; 13:20; 15:1; 17:17; also 1 Kings 3:9, 12 and 4:29–34 (review)

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that Proverbs teaches us how to make wise choices, and that true wisdom starts with trusting and obeying God.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* Two cups of water and two plants/flowers (or pictures), one bag of trail mix with a few "yucky" items mixed in (e.g., paper clips, clearly not edible, in a sealed bag for demo only).

1. Say: "I have a snack. It's mostly yummy... but there are a few things in here that would hurt you. Would you eat it without looking?" (No!)
2. "Making choices is like picking through this bag. We need wisdom to know what's good and what's harmful."
3. "Smart means you know a lot. **Wise** means you know what's right and you *do* it. Today we'll learn about the book of wise choices: Proverbs."

📖 **Story script**

> Remember King Solomon? When God said, "Ask for anything," Solomon asked for wisdom. God made Solomon the wisest man in the world. People came from far away just to hear him. The Bible says Solomon spoke 3,000 proverbs!
>
> A **proverb** is a short, wise saying that's easy to remember. Many of Solomon's proverbs, and some from other wise people, are collected in the book of **Proverbs**. It's like a dad giving his kids advice: "My son, listen to me. This is how to live a good life."

> The very first big lesson is this: "**The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge.**" That doesn't mean being scared of God like a monster. It means knowing how great and holy God is, loving Him, trusting Him, and wanting to obey Him. That's where wisdom starts!
>
> Proverbs has wise words about lots of things:
>
> About **trusting God**: "Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding." That means: trust God more than your own ideas.
>
> About **working hard**: "Go to the ant, you sluggard!" A sluggard is a lazy person. Ants don't have a boss telling them what to do, but they work hard all summer gathering food for winter. Be like the ant!
>
> About **words**: "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger." If someone yells at you and you yell back, it gets worse. But if you answer gently, the anger can calm down.
>
> About **friends**: "Walk with the wise and become wise." The friends you spend time with will shape who you become. And "A friend loves at all times."
>
> Proverbs also tells us about two ladies who call out to everyone passing by. One is **Lady Wisdom**. She says, "Come to me! Learn my ways and live!" The other is **Lady Folly** (foolishness). She says, "Come to me! Do whatever you want!" But her way leads to trouble. Every day, we choose whose voice to follow.
>
> The Bible says that Jesus is the true wisdom of God. When we follow Jesus, we're following the wisest way there is!

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Play "Wise or Not?" with thumbs up/down: "Sharing your toys?" 👍 "Hitting your brother?" 👎 "Saying sorry?" 👍 Show a real ant farm or ant pictures.
- **Explorers:** Give each child a Proverbs "fortune cookie" (a folded paper with one proverb). They read it and explain it in their own words.
- **Trailblazers:** Discuss Proverbs 13:20 and peer pressure. Have them identify one proverb about words, one about friends, one about work and one about money (e.g., 22:7 or 11:24–25).
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss Proverbs as principles vs. promises (compare 26:4 and 26:5, which seem to say opposite things; wisdom means knowing which applies when). Introduce the idea of starting a "Proverb a day" habit (31 chapters).

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) Who was the wisest king? (Solomon) 2) What little bug works hard? (The ant) 3) Is it wise to obey God? (Yes!)
- *Explorers:* 1) What's the difference between "smart" and "wise"? 2) What does "a gentle answer turns away wrath" mean? Give an example. 3) Why does it matter who your friends are?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) What does "the fear of the LORD" mean? 2) What does "lean not on your own understanding" look like in a real decision? 3) Where do you hear "Lady Folly's" voice in your life (ads, shows, friends)?

- *Ambassadors:* 1) Solomon knew all this wisdom and still made foolish choices (1 Kings 11). What does that teach us? 2) How does Jesus fulfill or embody Proverbs 8's picture of Wisdom? 3) Choose one proverb to practice all week. How will you do it?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "wisdom" / "Proverbs" / "Solomon asks for wisdom" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Proverbs | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Solomon's wisdom" / "Solomon" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Solomon | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | Likely title: "Overview: Proverbs"; bonus: "Wisdom Series" or "The Book of Proverbs" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Proverbs |

Follow-up questions: 1) What is wisdom? 2) Who are the two "ladies" in Proverbs, and what do they want?

> Preview every video first.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *Wise or Foolish Four Corners* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Ant Hill Wisdom craft* (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** P-R-O-V-E-R-B-S (Prov-erbs). Notice: Psalms and Proverbs both start with P! Little Lambs: "P, P, Psalms and Proverbs!" Trailblazers and Ambassadors: learn the bonus verse, Proverbs 3:5.

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> God, please make me wise. Help me trust You with all my heart, choose good friends, use kind words, and work hard. Thank You that Jesus shows me the wise way. Amen.

Week 4: What Really Matters & God's Strong Love

Scripture: Ecclesiastes 1:2; 3:1–8, 11; 4:9–12; 12:1, 13; Song of Songs 2:15; 8:6–7

Lesson goal: Kids will learn that Ecclesiastes teaches that only God gives life real meaning, and that Song of Songs celebrates love as God's good gift, pointing to God's love that is stronger than anything.

Opening hook / object lesson *Supplies:* A bottle of bubbles, a small mirror (or a cold window), and a rope made of three strands.

1. Blow bubbles. Let kids try to catch them. "What happens when you catch a bubble?" (It pops!)
2. Breathe on a mirror: see the fog? Watch it disappear. "The book of Ecclesiastes says that lots of things in life are like this: like a puff of breath. Here for a moment, then gone."
3. Hold up the three-strand rope. "But some things are strong and last. Let's find out what."

📖 Story script

> King Solomon was the richest, wisest king who ever lived. When he got older, he did an experiment. He wanted to find out: *What makes life really matter?*
>
> First he tried **learning**. He studied everything! But he said, "The more I know, the more I realize how much I don't know."
>
> Then he tried **fun**: parties, music, laughing. But when the party was over, he felt empty.
>
> Then he tried **building and getting stuff**: huge houses, gardens, pools, gold and silver, more than anyone. But he thought, "When I die, someone else will get all this."
>
> Then he tried **hard work**. But he said, "I work and work, and then I'm gone, and the work doesn't last forever either."
>
> He said, "**Meaningless! Meaningless!**" The word he used means a puff of breath or a bubble. Everything "under the sun," everything in life without God, is like trying to catch a bubble. Pop!
>
> But Solomon also noticed some beautiful things. He said, "**There is a time for everything**: a time to be born and a time to die, a time to cry and a time to laugh, a time to be sad and a time to dance." God made everything beautiful in its time. And God put a longing for *forever* in our hearts, because we were made for Him.
>
> He noticed that friends matter: "Two are better than one. If one falls down, the other can help him up." And "a cord of three strands is not quickly broken." When you have God with you and your friends, you're strong together.
>
> At the end of his experiment, Solomon wrote his answer. Are you ready? "**Remember your Creator in the days of your youth.**" That means while you're young, like you! And: "**Fear God and keep his commandments.**" That's what really matters. Knowing God makes life full of meaning!
>
> Solomon also wrote a song called the **Song of Songs**, which means "the best song." It's a love song about a bride and a groom who love each other very much. It reminds us that God made love and marriage, and it's good. The song says, "**Love is as strong as death. Many waters cannot put out love.**" You can't stop real love with a whole ocean!
>
> And do you know whose love is the strongest of all? **Jesus'** love. His love was stronger than death, because He died for us and rose again! Nothing can wash away His love for you.

Age-group teaching tips

- **Little Lambs:** Blow bubbles: "Toys are fun, but they don't last forever. God's love lasts forever!" Show a heart and a "squirt bottle" of water: "Water can't wash away God's love!" Keep Song of Songs to "God made moms and dads to love each other, and God loves us most of all."
- **Explorers:** Make a "time for everything" list: kids add their own pairs ("a time to play and a time to clean up," "a time for school and a time for summer").

- **Trailblazers:** Discuss the phrase "under the sun." What does life look like if there's no God? How does knowing God change that? Do the three-strand rope demonstration: try to break one strand, then three twisted together.
- **Ambassadors:** Discuss Ecclesiastes and culture: where do teens look for meaning (achievement, popularity, followers, pleasure)? For Song of Songs, discuss God's good design for love and marriage, and the repeated warning, "Do not arouse or awaken love until it so desires" (2:7; 3:5; 8:4). Consider splitting into small groups led by mature leaders.

💬 **Discussion questions**

- *Little Lambs:* 1) What happens to a bubble? (It pops!) 2) Whose love lasts forever? (God's / Jesus') 3) Who made love? (God)
- *Explorers:* 1) What did Solomon try to make life matter? 2) What's something that's "a time to..." for you? 3) What did Solomon say really matters at the end?
- *Trailblazers:* 1) Why do things like money and fun leave people feeling empty? 2) What does "God set eternity in the human heart" (3:11) mean? 3) Who are the "strands" in your cord of three?
- *Ambassadors:* 1) Can someone have everything and still feel empty? Why? 2) How does the resurrection of Jesus answer the "meaningless" problem (1 Corinthians 15:58)? 3) What does Song of Songs teach about how God sees love and marriage? How is this different from what culture says?

📺 **Video for the week** | Channel | Who watches | Search term | Link | |---|---|---|---| | @SharefaithKids | Little Lambs & Explorers | "God's love" / "a time for everything" | https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=God%27s+love | | @BibleJourneyTV | Explorers & Trailblazers | "Solomon" / "Ecclesiastes" | https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Ecclesiastes | | @bibleproject | Trailblazers & Ambassadors | Likely titles: "Overview: Ecclesiastes" and "Overview: Song of Songs" | https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Ecclesiastes |

Follow-up questions: 1) What does "meaningless" (hevel) really mean? 2) What does the Bible say is the strongest love?

> Preview every video first, especially "Overview: Song of Songs," which discusses romance and marriage tastefully but is best for Ambassadors (and Trailblazers at your discretion). Use only the Ecclesiastes video for younger groups.

🎮 **Game of the week:** *A Time for Everything Charades* (see Games)

✂️ **Activity of the week:** *Three-Strand Cord Bracelet* (see Activities & Crafts)

🔤 **Memory / Spelling focus:** E-C-C-L-E-S-I-A-S-T-E-S. Clap it: Ec-cle-si-as-tes (5 claps). And S-O-N-G O-F S-O-N-G-S. Say all 5 Poetry books, then all 22 books!

🙏 **Closing prayer**

> God, toys and stuff don't last, but You last forever. Help me remember You while I'm young. Thank You for Your love that is stronger than anything. In Jesus' name, amen.

Week 5 (optional): Praise Party! (Review & Fun Sunday)

Based on Psalm 150: "Let everything that has breath praise the LORD." Celebrate three complete sections (Law, History, Poetry)! Full plan under **End-of-Phase Review & Celebration**.

Book Memory Song & Motions

🎵 "Twenty-Two Books" (tune: *Jesus Loves Me*)

This song is cumulative: all 22 books from Genesis to Song of Songs. The new Poetry books are the chorus!

Verse 1: The Law (books 1–5)

> Genesis and Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers too, Deuteronomy makes five, These are Law books, give me five! *(high five!)*

Verse 2: History, part 1 (books 6–14)

> Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and then Samuel and Samuel, Kings and Kings and Chronicles, Chronicles, and on we go!

(Hold up 1 finger, then 2 fingers for the "First" and "Second" books.)

Verse 3: History, part 2 (books 15–17)

> Ezra, Nehemiah too, Esther: History is through! Twelve books tell what God has done, Now the poetry's begun!

Chorus: Poetry (books 18–22), NEW! *(tune of "Yes, Jesus loves me...")*

> Job and Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs makes five: Twenty-two books we know!

Shouts: "FIVE BOOKS OF LAW! TWELVE BOOKS OF HISTORY! FIVE BOOKS OF POETRY!" *(5 fingers, clap 12 times, 5 fingers)* **Big finish:** "TWENTY-TWO! WE KNOW TWENTY-TWO!"

> **Singing tip:** "Ecclesiastes" fits the melody of "Yes, Jesus loves me" exactly when you sing it "Ec-cle-si-as-tes" (5 notes). Practice that line slowly first!

Bonus "Lamp" verse (a sing-along paraphrase of the memory verse, same tune):

> Your word is a lamp for my feet, A light upon my path so sweet. When it's dark I will not fear, For Your Word shows me the way here.

(Always finish by saying the real verse word for word: Psalm 119:105.)

Hand motions for each book

Book	Motion
Genesis	Sunrise hands: palms together like a closed book, open them, sweep arms up like the sun rising
Exodus	Exit walk: walk two fingers across your palm and out the "door"
Leviticus	Holy hands: fold hands to pray, then raise them high
Numbers	Count 1-2-3-4 on fingers, then zig-zag your hand (wandering)
Deuteronomy	Two fingers up ("second"), tap head ("remember"), hand on heart
Joshua	March in place with fist-trumpet at mouth ("Walls fall down!")
Judges	Pound a gavel on your palm, then draw a circle (the cycle)
Ruth	Scoop up pretend grain, then hug yourself (loyal love)
1 & 2 Samuel	1/2 fingers, cup your ear
1 & 2 Kings	1/2 fingers, crown on head
1 & 2 Chronicles	1/2 fingers, unroll a scroll
Ezra	Stack fists (bricks)
Nehemiah	Hammer and shield
Esther	Crown, then "speak up" hands
Job	Open hands up, then fold over heart (trust)
Psalms	Strum a harp
Proverbs	Tap your head (think wise!)
Ecclesiastes	Blow a puff into your hand, then point up
Song of Songs	Make a heart with your hands

📣 Section Shout

Leader: "In the beginning there's the..." Kids: "**LAW!**" (5 fingers) Leader: "Then comes..." Kids: "**HISTORY!**" (clap 12) Leader: "In the middle, the heart of the Bible..." Kids: "**POETRY!**" (make a heart) Leader: "How many?" Kids: "**TWENTY-TWO!**"

Cumulative recall drill

1. **Lamp Light Line-Up:** Turn the lights down. The leader shines a flashlight on one child at a time; that child says the next book in order (Genesis → Song of Songs). Keep going around the circle until all 22 are said. Then start again faster.
2. **Section Sort:** Hand out 22 book cards. Kids run to three areas of the room labeled LAW, HISTORY and POETRY, then line up in order inside their section.
3. **Silent Song:** Do only the motions to the whole song while kids shout the book names.
4. **Missing Note:** The leader sings the song but hums one book; kids name the missing book.
5. **Countdown (Trailblazers/Ambassadors):** Say the 22 books backwards: Song of Songs → Genesis.

Tips for each age group

- **Little Lambs:** Learn the chorus and motions for the five Poetry books. Celebrate when they can say "Job, Psalms, Proverbs" (the easier three). Ecclesiastes can simply be "Ecclesi-ASTES!" with a puff of air.
- **Explorers:** Aim for all 22 with the song. Use Section Sort to help them see the three shelves.
- **Trailblazers:** All 22 without the song; say how many books are in each section (5-12-5).
- **Ambassadors:** Lead the song for the younger groups; know one famous verse from each Poetry book.

Spelling & Reading

Spelling lists by age group

Little Lambs (letter recognition, first sounds) | Word | First letter | Sound it out | |---|---|---| | Job | J | "J" like jump (and J-O-B is only 3 letters, so try spelling it!) | | Psalms | P | Silent P! It sounds like "S" 🤫 | | Proverbs | P | "P" like popcorn 🍿 | | Song | S | "Sss" like a snake | | lamp | L | "L" like a lollipop | | sheep | S | "Sh" like "shh!" |

Activity: Little Lambs spell J-O-B with big letter cards, their first whole book name! Play "Silent P": the leader says words that start with P, and when they hear "Psalms," kids put a finger to their lips: "Shh!"

Explorers (book names)

1. Job (J-O-B)
2. Psalms (P-S-A-L-M-S)
3. Proverbs (P-R-O-V-E-R-B-S)

4. Ecclesiastes (E-C-C-L-E-S-I-A-S-T-E-S)
5. Song of Songs (S-O-N-G O-F S-O-N-G-S) Bonus: shepherd, harp, wisdom.

Trailblazers (book names + 5 vocab words)

- All 5 Poetry book names (and all 22 books)
- **psalm:** a song or prayer to God
- **proverb:** a short, wise saying
- **wisdom:** knowing what is right and good, and doing it
- **praise:** telling God how great He is
- **redeemer:** someone who rescues or buys back another person

Ambassadors (book names + harder vocab with definitions)

- All 22 book names in order, spelled correctly
- **parallelism:** the way Hebrew poetry repeats or contrasts ideas in pairs of lines
- **lament:** a prayer or song of sadness or complaint brought to God
- **reverence:** deep respect and awe (as in "the fear of the LORD")
- **sovereignty:** God's complete authority and control over everything
- **hevel:** Hebrew word in Ecclesiastes meaning "vapor" or "breath" (NIV "meaningless")
- **acrostic:** a poem where each section starts with the next letter of the alphabet (Psalm 119)
- **doxology:** a short burst of praise to God (the end of each of the 5 books of Psalms)

Syllable-clap method

- Job (1 clap) → J-O-B
- Psalms (1 clap) → P-S-A-L-M-S ("P is silent but still there!")
- Prov-erbs (2 claps) → P-R-O-V-E-R-B-S
- Ec-cle-si-as-tes (5 claps) → E-C-C-L-E-S-I-A-S-T-E-S
- Song of Songs (3 claps) → S-O-N-G / O-F / S-O-N-G-S
- Shep-herd (2 claps) → S-H-E-P-H-E-R-D
- Wis-dom (2 claps) → W-I-S-D-O-M

Ecclesiastes spelling trick: Break it into 3 chunks: **ECCLE** + **SIAS** + **TES**. Or think: "**E**ach **C**hild **C**an **L**earn **E**cclesiastes" for the first five letters E-C-C-L-E, then "SI-AS-TES." Note the double **C** near the start: "Ec-cle."

"Spell It Out" relay: Harp Strings Edition

1. Stretch a long string or yarn "harp string" across the room at kid height for each team, with clothespins on it.
2. At the far end, put letter cards in a pile for each team.
3. Leader calls a book ("Proverbs!"). Runners take turns grabbing the next letter and clipping it onto the string in order.
4. First team to spell it correctly "plays" their harp (everyone strums the air and sings "Praise the LORD!").

5. *Younger:* Spell JOB only, or use whole book-name cards to clip the 5 Poetry books in order. *Older:* Spell ECCLESIASTES (12 letters!) as the championship round.

Mini spelling bee word list

Word	Use it in a sentence
Job	Job trusted God even when he lost everything.
Psalms	The book of Psalms has 150 songs.
Proverbs	Proverbs teaches us how to make wise choices.
Ecclesiastes	Ecclesiastes says there is a time for everything.
Song of Songs	Song of Songs is a love poem in the Bible.
shepherd	The LORD is my shepherd.
harp	David played the harp for King Saul.
wisdom	Solomon asked God for wisdom.
praise	Let everything that has breath praise the LORD.
lamp	God's Word is a lamp for my feet.
redeemer	Job said, "I know that my redeemer lives."
meaningless	Without God, life feels meaningless.

Read-aloud practice passage

Readers take turns, one line each (Psalm 23, NIV):

> The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing. He makes me lie down in green pastures, he leads me beside quiet waters, he refreshes my soul. He guides me along the right paths for his name's sake. Even though I walk through the darkest valley, I will fear no evil, for you are with me; your rod and your staff, they comfort me. You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil; my cup overflows. Surely your goodness and love will follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

Little Lambs: echo each line after the reader. *Explorers:* read a line each. *Trailblazers & Ambassadors:* read it in two groups, like a choir, and notice the parallel lines.

Word Trivia

⭐ Easy (Little Lambs / Explorers)

1. Who is "my shepherd" in Psalm 23?
2. What instrument did David play?

3. Which tiny bug does Proverbs say works hard?
4. Who was the wisest king?
5. How many books of Poetry are there?
6. **True or False:** Job stopped loving God when bad things happened.
7. **Fill in the blank:** "Your word is a _____ for my feet."
8. **Fill in the blank:** "Let everything that has _____ praise the LORD."
9. Which book is God's songbook?
10. **True or False:** God made love and marriage.
11. Which Poetry book name has only 3 letters?
12. What is silent in the word "Psalms"?

⭐⭐ Medium (Explorers / Trailblazers)

13. How many psalms are in the book of Psalms?
14. **Who said it?** "The LORD gave and the LORD has taken away; may the name of the LORD be praised."
15. **Which book?** "There is a time for everything."
16. **Which book?** "Trust in the LORD with all your heart."
17. How many days did Job's friends sit with him without saying anything?
18. What is the shortest psalm (and shortest chapter in the Bible)?
19. What is the longest psalm (and longest chapter in the Bible)?
20. **Fill in the blank:** "A gentle answer turns away _____."
21. **True or False:** David wrote all 150 psalms.
22. How did God speak to Job at the end of the book?
23. **Which book?** "Many waters cannot quench love."
24. How many chapters does Proverbs have?
25. **Fill in the blank:** "Remember your _____ in the days of your youth."

⭐⭐⭐ Hard (Trailblazers / Ambassadors)

26. **Who said it?** "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" (two answers)
27. Name Job's three friends.
28. **Fill in the blank:** "The fear of the LORD is the _____ of knowledge." (Proverbs 1:7)
29. What does the Hebrew word *hevel* (NIV "meaningless") literally mean?
30. **Who said it?** "Where were you when I laid the earth's foundation?"
31. In what land did Job live?
32. Which psalm is credited to Moses?
33. How many proverbs did Solomon speak according to 1 Kings 4:32?
34. What is "parallelism" in Hebrew poetry?
35. **True or False:** Proverbs are guaranteed promises that always happen exactly as written.
36. Psalm 119 is an acrostic with 22 sections. What is each section based on?
37. Into how many "books" (smaller collections) is the book of Psalms divided?
38. Who wrote Proverbs 31 (according to verse 1)?
39. **Who said it?** "I know that my redeemer lives, and that in the end he will stand on the earth."

Answer Key

1. The LORD (God) 2. The harp (lyre) 3. The ant (Proverbs 6:6) 4. Solomon 5. Five 6. False 7. lamp 8. breath (Psalm 150:6) 9. Psalms 10. True 11. Job 12. The P
2. 150 14. Job (1:21) 15. Ecclesiastes (3:1) 16. Proverbs (3:5) 17. Seven days and seven nights (2:13) 18. Psalm 117 (2 verses) 19. Psalm 119 (176 verses) 20. wrath (anger) (15:1) 21. False. David wrote about 73; others were by Asaph, the sons of Korah, Solomon, Moses and unnamed writers. 22. Out of a storm / whirlwind (38:1) 23. Song of Songs (8:7) 24. 31 25. Creator (Ecclesiastes 12:1)
3. David wrote it (Psalm 22:1), and Jesus prayed it on the cross (Matthew 27:46) 27. Eliphaz, Bildad and Zophar 28. beginning 29. Vapor, breath or mist 30. God (Job 38:4) 31. Uz (Job 1:1) 32. Psalm 90 33. 3,000 34. Pairs of lines that repeat, build on, or contrast the same idea 35. False. They are wise principles about how life generally works. 36. The 22 letters of the Hebrew alphabet (each section's verses start with the same letter) 37. Five (1–41, 42–72, 73–89, 90–106, 107–150) 38. King Lemuel (taught by his mother) 39. Job (19:25)

Games

> More game ideas and general rules: see `../00-start-here/game-library.md`.

🎮 1. Storm and Stars Freeze (Week 1)

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Music (or a drum), a flashlight, picture cards of animals and nature from Job 38–39 (lion, eagle, horse, ostrich, mountain goat, stars, snow, rain, sea)
- **Setup:** Open space. Dim the lights a little for "storm" mood if appropriate (keep it fun, not scary).
- **How to play:** Kids move around the room while music plays (the "storm"). When it stops, everyone freezes. The leader flashes a picture card and asks, "Can YOU make a ___?" ("Can you tell the eagle where to fly?") Everyone shouts, "No, but GOD can!" Then the leader asks one book-order question to a frozen child ("What comes after Esther?"). If the child is right, they become the next "storm leader."
- **How to win:** Everyone wins when all 22 books have been named in order through the rounds.
- **Adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Just the "Can you...?" part with animal pictures and motions (roar like a lion, fly like an eagle). *Older:* Require them to say the section the book is in, too.
- **Learning goal:** God's greatness from Job 38–39; book order review.

🎮 2. Shepherd and Sheep Tag (Week 2)

- **Best for:** Little Lambs, Explorers, Trailblazers
- **Supplies:** A "shepherd's staff" (pool noodle or cardboard tube), a "sheepfold" area marked with tape or cones, one or two "wolf" headbands
- **Setup:** Mark a safe sheepfold at one end. One teacher or older kid is the Shepherd; one or two kids are Wolves.

- **How to play:** Sheep (most kids) "graze" in the open field. When the Shepherd calls, "The LORD is my shepherd!", sheep run toward the sheepfold. Wolves try to tag sheep before they get there. The Shepherd can "protect" any sheep by touching them with the staff (they're safe). Tagged sheep must say one Poetry book (or the next book after one the Wolf names) to return to the flock, because "He restores my soul!"
- **How to win:** No one is ever out; the goal is to get the whole flock home. Switch roles often.
- **Adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Wolves walk on tiptoe; teachers help. *Ambassadors:* Act as shepherds and help the youngest sheep.
- **Learning goal:** Psalm 23; Jesus as the Good Shepherd; book review.

🎮 3. Wise or Foolish Four Corners (Week 3)

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors (Little Lambs with two corners: "Wise" and "Not Wise")
- **Supplies:** Four signs: "WISE 👍," "FOOLISH 👎," "PROVERBS SAYS..." and "WHICH BOOK?"
- **How to play:** Leader reads a situation or statement. Kids run to the corner they think fits:
  - Situations ("Your friend yells at you. You answer gently.") → WISE or FOOLISH
  - "Proverbs says... go to the ___!" → kids at the PROVERBS SAYS corner shout the answer
  - "Which book says 'The LORD is my shepherd'?" → kids at WHICH BOOK? shout the answer
    The leader announces which corner was right for each question. Kids in the right corner get a point.
- **How to win:** Kids track their own points; the top three get to choose the next game.
- **Adaptations:** *Younger:* Only use WISE and FOOLISH corners with very simple choices. *Older:* Use real proverbs and ask kids to explain.
- **Learning goal:** Applying Proverbs; matching verses to books.

🎮 4. Ant Relay (Week 3)

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** A bowl of dried beans, cotton balls or cereal ("food") at one end; an empty cup ("anthill") for each team at the other end; spoons
- **How to play:** Like the hard-working ant (Proverbs 6:6–8), each runner carries one "food" piece on a spoon to their anthill. Before dropping it in, they must say the next book of the Bible in order (team keeps going from Genesis).
- **How to win:** First team to collect 22 pieces (one for each book, in order) wins and shouts, "Go to the ant and be wise!"
- **Adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Carry with hands, not spoons; teacher says the book and they repeat. *Older:* Carry two pieces at once and say two books.
- **Learning goal:** Book order; Proverbs' lesson about hard work.

🎮 5. A Time for Everything Charades (Week 4)

- **Best for:** All ages
- **Supplies:** Cards with Ecclesiastes 3 pairs ("a time to cry / a time to laugh," "a time to plant / a time to pull up," "a time to be quiet / a time to speak," "a time to tear / a time to mend," "a time to dance") plus book-name cards for the 5 Poetry books

- **How to play:** One child acts out a card while their team guesses. If it's an Ecclesiastes pair, they act out both halves. If it's a book card, they use the book's hand motion and the team must guess the book.
- **How to win:** Points for each correct guess within 30 seconds.
- **Adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Teacher acts; kids guess "Cry! Laugh!" *Ambassadors:* Act out a famous verse from each Poetry book.
- **Learning goal:** Ecclesiastes 3; Poetry book motions.

🎮 6. Harp Hot Potato (any week / review)

- **Best for:** Little Lambs, Explorers
- **Supplies:** A toy instrument or homemade shaker (the "harp"), music
- **How to play:** Kids sit in a circle passing the "harp" while music plays. When the music stops, the child holding it says one book of the Bible (Little Lambs: any book or a Poetry book; Explorers: the next book in order). Then the whole class "plays" their pretend harps and sings the chorus of the book song.
- **How to win:** Everyone wins when the class gets through all 22 books.
- **Adaptations:** *Older:* The holder must say a verse or fact from the book they name.
- **Learning goal:** Book recall; joyful praise.

🎮 7. Lamp to My Feet Path (memory verse game)

- **Best for:** Explorers, Trailblazers, Ambassadors
- **Supplies:** Flashlights, a blindfold, paper "stepping stones" each with one word of Psalm 119:105 (10–12 stones)
- **Setup:** Lay the stepping stones out in a winding path in a dimmed room.
- **How to play:** One child is blindfolded (or walks with eyes closed). A partner holds a flashlight and gives directions only by reading the words on the stones as they step on each one ("Your... word... is... a... lamp..."). The walker repeats each word. Swap roles.
- **How to win:** Teams that finish the path and can say the whole verse without help earn a "lamp" sticker.
- **Adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* No blindfold; just hop stone to stone saying the short verse with a teacher holding a flashlight.
- **Learning goal:** Memorizing Psalm 119:105 and understanding it (God's Word shows the next step).

Coloring Pages

> 🖍️ Printable book-name coloring sheet and word search: see `../printables/phase-06-printables.html`

Page 1 (Week 1): "Where Were You?"

- **Scene:** Job, a bearded man in simple clothes, sitting on the ground and looking up in wonder. Above him, a dramatic storm cloud opens to a starry sky. Around the edges: a lion, an eagle, a horse, an ostrich, a mountain goat and ocean waves (the animals and wonders God describes in Job 38–39).
- **Caption:** "I know that my redeemer lives." (Job 19:25)
- **Conversation prompts:** Which of God's creations in the picture is your favorite? How does looking at God's creation help us trust Him?

Page 2 (Week 2): "The LORD Is My Shepherd"

- **Scene:** Young David sitting on a rock playing his harp, with sheep lying in green grass and a quiet stream nearby. A shepherd's staff leans on the rock. Music notes float across the page with little words: happy, sad, sorry, thank You.
- **Caption:** "The LORD is my shepherd, I lack nothing." (Psalm 23:1)
- **Conversation prompts:** How does a shepherd take care of sheep? How does Jesus take care of you?

Page 3 (Week 2 bonus): "Praise Party!"

- **Scene:** Kids of different ages and backgrounds marching in a parade with trumpets, harps, tambourines, cymbals and ribbons, with big letters "PRAISE THE LORD!" across the top.
- **Caption:** "Let everything that has breath praise the LORD." (Psalm 150:6)
- **Conversation prompts:** What instrument would you play for God? What's one thing you want to praise God for?

Page 4 (Week 3): "Go to the Ant"

- **Scene:** A cheerful line of ants carrying crumbs into an anthill under a big sunflower. A boy and girl crouch down watching with a magnifying glass. A scroll at the bottom reads "WISDOM."
- **Caption:** "Trust in the LORD with all your heart." (Proverbs 3:5)
- **Conversation prompts:** What can we learn from ants? What's one wise choice you can make this week?

Page 5 (Week 4): "A Time for Everything"

- **Scene:** A big circle divided into four seasons (spring flowers, summer sun, fall leaves, winter snow), with a clock in the center. Around the outside, small pictures: a baby, a laughing face, a crying face, a seed being planted, kids dancing. At the bottom, a three-strand rope tied in a bow.
- **Caption:** "Remember your Creator in the days of your youth." (Ecclesiastes 12:1)
- **Conversation prompts:** What season is your favorite? What's "a time to ____" in your life right now?

Page 6 (Book-name page): "The Poetry Shelf"

- **Scene:** A bookshelf with five books standing up, each with a symbol on the spine: JOB (storm cloud), PSALMS (harp), PROVERBS (ant), ECCLESIASTES (puff of breath and clock), SONG OF SONGS (heart). A glowing oil lamp sits on top of the shelf. A banner reads "5 BOOKS OF POETRY • 22 OF 66."
- **Caption:** "Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105)
- **Conversation prompts:** Can you read all five book names? Which Poetry book would you like to read at home first?

Activities & Crafts

✂️ 1. "Where Were You?" Star Chart (Week 1)

- **Supplies:** Black or dark blue construction paper, star stickers or white/yellow gel pens, white crayon
- **Steps:**
  1. Read Job 38:4–7 and 38:31–33 (God asks about the stars and constellations).
  2. Kids cover their paper with as many stars as they can.
  3. At the bottom, write: "God made every star, and He takes care of me."
  4. Older kids can try to count their stars, then talk about how God "determines the number of the stars and calls them each by name" (Psalm 147:4).
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Stickers only; teacher writes. *Explorers:* Make the Big Dipper or Orion (Job 9:9 mentions Orion and the Pleiades!). *Trailblazers/Ambassadors:* Write one of God's questions from Job 38 and an answer of trust.
- **What it teaches:** God is great and wise; we can trust Him like Job.

✂️ 2. Psalm 150 Instruments (Week 2)

- **Supplies:** *Shakers:* paper plates, dried beans, stapler, ribbons. *Harps:* small sturdy boxes (tissue boxes or shoe box lids), rubber bands of different thicknesses. *Tambourines:* paper plates, jingle bells, pipe cleaners. Markers and stickers.
- **Steps:**
  1. Let each child choose an instrument to make.
  2. Write "Praise the LORD! Psalm 150" on it.
  3. Decorate it.
  4. End class with a Psalm 150 praise parade around the room or church.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Paper plate shakers (sealed well by a teacher). *Explorers:* Rubber-band harps; experiment with how thicker bands make lower sounds. *Older:* Write their own praise lines on the instrument.
- **Safety:** Seal beans well; supervise Little Lambs with small parts.
- **What it teaches:** Psalms is God's songbook; praise God with everything.

✂️ 3. Ant Hill Wisdom Craft (Week 3)

- **Supplies:** Brown paper bags or brown paper cones (the anthill), black pom-poms or thumbprints with black ink pads, googly eyes (optional), pipe cleaners, small paper strips
- **Steps:**
  1. Make ants: three black pom-poms glued in a row (or three thumbprints), plus pipe cleaner or drawn legs.
  2. Write one proverb on each paper strip ("A friend loves at all times," "A gentle answer turns away wrath," "Go to the ant and be wise," "Trust in the LORD with all your heart").
  3. Glue each strip so the ant is "carrying" it into the anthill.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Thumbprint ants with one strip: "Be wise!" *Older:* Each child writes a proverb in their own words and how they'll apply it.
- **What it teaches:** Proverbs gives wise words for daily life; working hard and making good choices.

✂️ 4. Lamp for My Feet (memory verse craft, any week)

- **Supplies:** Air-dry clay (or paper cutouts of an oil lamp), a battery tea light, paint or markers, a paper footprint cutout for each child
- **Steps:**
  1. Shape a small ancient-style oil lamp from clay (a pinched bowl with a spout), or cut one from yellow paper.
  2. Place a battery tea light inside (or draw a flame).
  3. Trace the child's foot on paper and write Psalm 119:105 on the footprint.
  4. Display the lamp on the footprint.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Paper version; short verse. *Older:* Clay version; write the full verse and reference.
- **What it teaches:** God's Word guides our next step, like a lamp in the dark.

✂️ 5. Three-Strand Cord Bracelet (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Embroidery floss or yarn in three colors (gold for God, plus two other colors for "me" and "a friend"), tape
- **Steps:**
  1. Cut three strands about 12" long and knot them together at one end.
  2. Tape the knot to the table.
  3. Braid the three strands.
  4. Knot the end and tie it around a wrist.
  5. Talk about Ecclesiastes 4:12: "A cord of three strands is not quickly broken."
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Teacher pre-braids or helps; kids pick colors. Try breaking one strand, then the braid! *Ambassadors:* Make extra bracelets and give them to a younger friend with a note of encouragement.
- **What it teaches:** Friendship with God at the center; we're stronger together.

✂️ 6. Seasons Wheel (Week 4)

- **Supplies:** Two paper plates per child, a brad fastener, markers, scissors
- **Steps:**
  1. Divide the bottom plate into four sections and draw a pair from Ecclesiastes 3 in each ("a time to plant / a time to harvest," "a time to cry / a time to laugh," "a time to be quiet / a time to speak," "a time to mourn / a time to dance").
  2. Cut a quarter "window" out of the top plate and write on it "God makes everything beautiful in its time" (3:11).
  3. Attach the plates with a brad so the top plate turns.
- **Age adaptations:** *Little Lambs:* Use four seasons (spring, summer, fall, winter) with stickers. *Older:* Add a personal "time" they're in right now.
- **What it teaches:** God is in charge of every season of life.

✂️ 7. My Own Psalm (Trailblazers & Ambassadors)

- **Supplies:** Nice paper or journals, pens, colored pencils
- **Steps:**
  1. Choose a type of psalm: praise, thanks, sorry, or a lament (sad song).
  2. Write 4–8 lines, using parallelism (say each idea twice in different words).
  3. Decorate the border.
  4. Optional: share with the group or give to a family member.
- **What it teaches:** We can talk honestly with God; how Hebrew poetry works.

Word Puzzles

Word scramble

#	Scrambled	Hint
1	BOJ	He trusted God when life hurt
2	SLAMPS	God's songbook
3	BERPROVS	Book of wise sayings
4	SEASILECCTES	"A time for everything"
5	GNOS	___ of Songs
6	DERPHEHS	"The LORD is my ___"
7	PRAH	David's instrument
8	MODWIS	What Solomon asked for
9	PALM	"Your word is a ___ for my feet"
10	THILG	"...a ___ on my path"
11	ESARIP	"Let everything that has breath ___ the LORD"

#	Scrambled	Hint
12	TAN	A small, hard-working bug
13	EERDEMER	"I know that my ___ lives"
14	VOLE	Stronger than death

Answer key: 1. JOB 2. PSALMS 3. PROVERBS 4. ECCLESIASTES 5. SONG 6. SHEPHERD 7. HARP 8. WISDOM 9. LAMP 10. LIGHT 11. PRAISE 12. ANT 13. REDEEMER 14. LOVE

Fill-in-the-blank story

Word bank: *Job, trust, Psalms, shepherd, 150, Proverbs, ant, Ecclesiastes, Creator, love, lamp, Jesus*

> The Poetry books sit in the middle of the Bible. First comes _____, a man who lost almost everything but still chose to _____ God. Next is _____, God's songbook with _____ songs. David wrote, "The LORD is my _____." Then comes _____, full of wise sayings like "Go to the _____ and be wise!" In _____, Solomon said, "Remember your _____ in the days of your youth." Song of Songs shows that God made _____. All these books tell us God's Word is a _____ for our feet, and they point us to _____, the Good Shepherd and the wisdom of God!

Answer key: Job, trust, Psalms, 150, shepherd, Proverbs, ant, Ecclesiastes, Creator, love, lamp, Jesus

Match the book to its picture / summary

Book		Picture & summary
1. Job		A. 🎵 God's songbook: 150 songs and prayers for every feeling.
2. Psalms		B. ❤️ A love poem showing God made love and marriage good.
3. Proverbs		C. ⛈️ A man suffers, asks hard questions, and learns to trust God.
4. Ecclesiastes		D. 🐜 Short wise sayings about words, friends, work and trusting God.
5. Song of Songs		E. 💨 Life without God is like a puff of breath; remember your Creator!
6. Nehemiah (review)		F. 🧱 A cupbearer rebuilds Jerusalem's walls in 52 days.

Answer key: 1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-E, 5-B, 6-F

Questions for Every Age

Little Lambs (ages 4–6)

1. When you feel sad, who can you talk to? (God!)
2. What song can you sing to God?
3. How does Jesus take care of you like a shepherd?

4. What is one wise choice you can make today? (Share, obey, be kind)
5. Who loves you more than anyone? (God / Jesus)

Explorers (ages 7–10)

1. What is something hard in your life that you can trust God with?
2. Which feeling (happy, sad, scared, sorry) do you most want to talk to God about this week?
3. What's a proverb you can practice at school?
4. What are some things that don't last forever? What lasts forever?
5. How can you show God's love to someone this week?

Trailblazers (ages 11–13)

1. Why is it okay (and even good) to be honest with God about how you feel?
2. Job's friends gave bad advice. How can you be a good friend when someone is hurting?
3. Who are the "wise" people you walk with (Proverbs 13:20)? Who might be pulling you toward folly?
4. Where do people your age look for meaning and happiness? Does it last?
5. How does God's Word act like a lamp in your life? Give a real example.

Ambassadors (ages 14–17)

1. When you're suffering or watching someone suffer, what helps you hold on to faith? What doesn't help?
2. Pick a psalm that matches how you're feeling right now. What does it teach you to say to God?
3. Which area of your life most needs Proverbs' wisdom right now: words, friends, work, money, or relationships?
4. Ecclesiastes says God "set eternity in the human heart." How do you see that longing in yourself and in your friends?
5. What does the Bible's view of love and marriage (Song of Songs; Genesis 2; Ephesians 5) say to a culture that often treats love as just a feeling?

Big Questions for Ambassadors (apologetics / worldview)

1. **"If God is good and all-powerful, why is there suffering?"** *Suggested answer:* This is called "the problem of evil," and Job wrestles with it honestly. Christianity's answer has several parts: (1) God created a good world, but human sin broke it (Genesis 3; Romans 8:20–22); (2) real love requires real freedom, which makes evil possible; (3) God can bring good out of suffering, even if we can't see it now (Romans 8:28; Genesis 50:20); (4) our view is limited, as God showed Job (Job 38–42); (5) most importantly, God didn't stay distant from suffering. In Jesus, He entered it, suffered with us and for us, and rose to defeat death. One day He will wipe away every tear (Revelation 21:4). We may not know every "why," but we can know the "Who."
2. **"Is the Bible against feelings? Aren't Christians supposed to be happy all the time?"** *Suggested answer:* No! About a third of the Psalms are laments: sad, angry, confused prayers. Jesus wept (John 11:35) and was "overwhelmed with sorrow" (Matthew 26:38). The Bible teaches us to bring

every feeling to God, not hide it. Christian joy (Nehemiah 8:10) isn't pretending to be happy; it's trust that God is with us and will make things right, even in tears.

3. **"Isn't 'the fear of the LORD' an unhealthy way to relate to God?"** *Suggested answer:* Biblical "fear of the LORD" is not terror of a cruel God. It's the awe and reverence you'd feel standing at the edge of the Grand Canyon, combined with trust and love that make you want to obey. It's the right response to how great and holy God really is. Through Jesus, we can approach this awesome God as our loving Father (Romans 8:15; Hebrews 4:16). Awe and closeness go together, and that's actually the healthiest relationship possible.

End-of-Phase Review & Celebration

Praise Party plan (last Sunday, 75 minutes; Psalm 150)

Time	What happens
0–10 min	**Praise Parade:** Kids bring their Psalm 150 instruments and march around the room (or through the church hallway, with permission) singing "Twenty-Two Books" with motions. Ambassadors lead the parade.
10–25 min	**Poetry Shelf Stations:** Five stations, one per book: (1) Job: Storm and Stars "Can you…?" questions; (2) Psalms: Write or illustrate a one-line praise; (3) Proverbs: Ant Relay mini round; (4) Ecclesiastes: Time-for-everything charades; (5) Song of Songs: Make a "God's love" heart card for a family member. Rotate every 3 minutes.
25–35 min	**Favorite Video Rewatch** (kids vote)
35–50 min	**Poetry Bible Bowl:** Teams compete with the Word Trivia questions. Use instruments as "buzzers."
50–60 min	**Lamp Light Line-Up:** Dim the lights, and use flashlights for the all-22-books recall drill.
60–70 min	**Honey & Wisdom Snack + Check-offs:** "How sweet are your words to my taste, sweeter than honey to my mouth!" (Psalm 119:103). Serve honey graham crackers or honey sticks *(check allergies first)*. Teachers do individual check-offs.
70–75 min	**Passport Stamps, Badges & Prayer:** Close with everyone reading Psalm 150:6 together.

Oral check-off checklist

Little Lambs (ages 4–6)

- [ ] Says "Poetry" for this kind of book
- [ ] Names 3 Poetry books (e.g., Job, Psalms, Proverbs) with motions
- [ ] Says the short verse: "Your word is a lamp for my feet."
- [ ] Spells J-O-B (with or without letter cards)

Explorers (ages 7–10)

- [ ] Says all 5 Poetry books in order
- [ ] Spells JOB, PSALMS, PROVERBS and SONG OF SONGS correctly (bonus: ECCLESIASTES)
- [ ] Says all 22 books from Genesis to Song of Songs (with the song is OK)
- [ ] Says the memory verse (Psalm 119:105)

Trailblazers (ages 11–13)

- [ ] Says all 22 books in order without the song
- [ ] Gives a one-sentence summary of each Poetry book
- [ ] Names the three sections so far with the number of books in each (5-12-5)
- [ ] Says the memory verse and the bonus verse (Proverbs 3:5) with references

Ambassadors (ages 14–17)

- [ ] Says all 22 books in order and names each section
- [ ] Explains Hebrew parallelism with an example
- [ ] Teaches one Poetry book to a younger child (name, motion, famous verse, how it points to Jesus)
- [ ] Says the memory verse and bonus verse with references

🛂 Bible Passport stamp

Stamp the "Songs & Wise Words" page. Stamp design: a harp next to a glowing oil lamp with "JOB • PSALMS • PROVERBS • ECCL • SONG" around the edge. Add a **"POETRY COMPLETE!"** sticker. Kids have now finished three whole sections of the Bible library and the entire first third of the Bible (22 of 66 books).

🏅 Badge description: The Lamp & Harp Badge

A round lamplight-gold badge with a teal border. In the center, a small harp with a glowing oil lamp beside it and three tiny music notes. Around the edge: "SONGS & WISE WORDS • 22 OF 66 • POETRY ✔." (Sticker, button or sash patch.)

📜 Certificate wording

> **Songs & Wisdom Certificate** This certifies that _____ has completed **Phase 6: Songs & Wise Words** at Purpose Church Sunday School. You have learned the books of **Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes and Song of Songs** and completed **all 5 books of Poetry**. You now know **22 of the 66 books** of the Bible: one-third of the whole library! *"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105)* Keep singing to God, keep choosing wisdom, and remember: Jesus is your Good Shepherd. Teacher: _____ Date: _____

Take-Home Family Page

> ✂️ *Copy this page and send it home on the first Sunday of the month.*

Dear Parents and Caregivers, This month your child is learning **Phase 6: Songs & Wise Words**, the five Poetry books of the Bible: **Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes and Song of Songs.** We'll learn that we can trust God when life hurts (Job), talk and sing to God about everything (Psalms), make wise choices (Proverbs), find real meaning in God (Ecclesiastes), and celebrate God's gift of love (Song of Songs, taught in an age-appropriate way). The big idea: **God's Word is a lamp that guides us, and Jesus is our Good Shepherd and the wisdom of God.** Your child now knows **22 of the 66 books** of the Bible!

📖 **Memory Verse:** "Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." (Psalm 119:105, NIV) **Little Lambs:** "Your word is a lamp for my feet." **Bonus (older kids):** "Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding." (Proverbs 3:5)

🎵 **Our Song (tune: *Jesus Loves Me*)**

> Genesis and Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers too, Deuteronomy makes five, these are Law books, give me five! Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and then Samuel and Samuel, Kings and Kings and Chronicles, Chronicles, and on we go! Ezra, Nehemiah too, Esther: History is through! Twelve books tell what God has done, now the poetry's begun! *Chorus:* Job and Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs makes five: Twenty-two books we know!

🍽️ **Dinner-table questions**

1. If you wrote a song to God today, would it be a happy song, a sad song, a sorry song or a thank-you song? Why?
2. What's one wise choice and one foolish choice someone could make at school this week?
3. What are some things that don't last, and what lasts forever?

🏠 **Family activity: "Proverb of the Day"** Proverbs has 31 chapters. Each day this month, read a few verses from the chapter that matches the date (e.g., on the 15th, read from Proverbs 15). Let each family member pick one favorite verse and write it on a sticky note on the fridge. At the end of the week, see who can remember the most! For younger children, read Psalm 23 together at bedtime each night until they can say verse 1 by heart.

📺 **Videos to watch at home (search on YouTube; parents, please preview)**

- @SharefaithKids: search "Psalm 23" → https://www.youtube.com/@SharefaithKids/search?query=Psalm+23
- @BibleJourneyTV: search "Job" → https://www.youtube.com/@BibleJourneyTV/search?query=Job
- @bibleproject: "Overview: Job," "Overview: Psalms," "Overview: Proverbs," "Overview: Ecclesiastes" → https://www.youtube.com/@bibleproject/search?query=Proverbs *(BibleProject's*

"Overview: Song of Songs" is recommended for teens; parents, please preview.)

Thank you for partnering with us! For more about the program, see `../00-start-here/program-overview.md`.